# Seth Strickland

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## Profile

Academic operations specialist with a PhD and experience supporting graduate programs, faculty affairs, and cross-unit initiatives at a research university. Trusted partner to department leadership on recruitment, handbook and RPT processes, program launches, and organizational assessment—combining clear written communication with data-informed review and stakeholder coordination across faculty, staff, and college-level offices.

## Core Competencies

Graduate Recruitment & Admissions • Retention, Promotion & Tenure (RPT) Support • Handbook & Policy Review • Program & Certificate Launch • Academic Affairs Assessment • Staffing & Adjunct-Appointment Planning • Graduate Data Review • Stakeholder & Event Coordination • Grant & Program Proposals • Public-Facing Communications • Workday-Ready Documentation • LaTeX, Markdown, Excel

## Experience

**Academic and Administrative Operations Advisor (Special Faculty)** **Oct – Dec 2026**
*Carnegie Mellon University, Department of English, Pittsburgh, PA*

- Extension of part-time special faculty appointment (∼10–15 hrs/week), reporting to the Department Head; supported English graduate program operations alongside a continuing Lecturer role.
- Led graduate recruitment: campaign planning, applicant follow-up, and review of Dietrich College graduate applications; refined public-facing graduate recruitment FAQs.
- Coordinated PhD certificate launch with staff and faculty; collaborated on graduate handbook revisions and RPT processes; conducted graduate student data review.
- Assessed departmental administrative structure for academic affairs, staff duty assignments, and part-time adjunct appointment needs.

**Graduate Advisor (Special Faculty)** **Sep – Oct 2026**
*Carnegie Mellon University, Department of English, Pittsburgh, PA*

- Part-time special faculty appointment (∼10 hrs/week): graduate recruitment and Dietrich application review; AI-assisted grad recruitment FAQs; PhD certificate coordination; handbook and RPT support; graduate data review.

**Lecturer, Writing & Communication** **2023 – Present**
*Carnegie Mellon University, Pittsburgh, PA*

- Design and deliver writing and communication courses for interdisciplinary undergraduates; develop reusable curricular materials and student-facing guides at scale (50+ students per term).
- Member, Diversity, Equity, and Inclusion Working Group, Department of English.
- Provost's Inclusive Teaching Fellow.

**Founder & Coordinator** **2025 – 2026**
*Computational Humanities Initiatives, CMU, Pittsburgh, PA*

- Founded and ran cross-departmental research programming—including a series that became a required graduate seminar—in partnership with the Posner Center and CMU Libraries.
- Managed event logistics, scheduling, and multi-unit stakeholder communication.

**Program Collaborator** **AY 2026–27**
*Beatrice Institute, Pittsburgh, PA*

- Co-proposed an eight-event undergraduate series; secured a $20,000 Collegiate Cultural Foundation grant (awarded without revision) with three co-proposers.
- Seminar leader for a seven-session undergraduate series on courtship, dating, and marriage.

**Graduate Leadership & Instruction (earlier)** **2014 – 2023**
*Cornell University & Saint Louis University, Ithaca, NY / St. Louis, MO*

- President, Medieval Studies Graduate Organization; Graduate Policy and Liaison Committee member (Cornell).
- EGSO event planner and treasurer; Graduate Student Association representative for English (Saint Louis University).
- Instructor of Record and Martino Lecturer across writing and literature courses.

## Education

**PhD, Medieval Literature** — Cornell University 2022

**MA, English** — Saint Louis University 2016

**BA, Classics & English Literature** — Hillsdale College 2012